



THE
SUPREME
COURT

SUPREME COURT
OF THE VIBE JUSTICE SYSTEM (VJS)

Neutral Citation Number

[2026] LEXBY-SC 3

IN THE MATTER OF

Four foundational questions on the constitution of the court: researched intake and the apex observer; permission to appeal by an independent leave-judge; a per-turn watchdog and a deterministic citation gate; and the circumstances, form, and review of the leapfrog certificate.

Before:

Hallam CJ, Goffe J, Blackmere J, Sumberly J, Elden J, Coade J, Steyne J, Bowan J,
Aldermere J

Date: 5 June 2026

REQUEST FOR RULING

JUDGMENT

1. IN THE SUPREME COURT OF THE VIBE JUSTICE SYSTEM
2. FULL COURT OF NINE (constitutional sitting)
3. Neutral citation: [2026] LEXBY-SC 4
4. LEADING JUDGMENT OF HALLAM CJ
5. (delivering the judgment of the Court)
6. ---
7. ****1. BENCH AND PROCEDURE****
8. This Court sits as the full Court of nine in constitutional configuration, the questions being foundational to the constitution of the Court itself (s. 18, VPR 5). The bench comprises Hallam CJ, Goffe J, Blackmere J, Sumerly J, Elden J, Coade J, Steyne J, Aldermere J, and Bowan J. The matter is seised by the Principal's express leapfrog certificate under VPR 4 and s. 13. Standing is uncontested and the questions fall squarely within s. 14 subject-matter jurisdiction. No question is struck out at intake; the defendant's threshold motions are addressed and disposed of on the merits below.
9. A preliminary correction binds the whole Court. The clerk's proposed citation, "[2026] LEXBY-SC 1," is occupied by the founding ruling, as are SC 2 and SC 3. The correct neutral citation for this judgment is ****[2026] LEXBY-SC 4****, and the clerk is directed to enact it as such with its citator row in the same commit (s. 11(d)). The case file's recital that SPEC-LAW and the citator do not exist in the working directory is, as every member of the bench independently found, false: both exist and are good law, and the Court has decided on the authentic statute and citator, not on the empty record it was handed. A ruling rendered in ignorance of the governing statute would be per incuriam and void (s. 11(e)); this judgment is not. That this very matter, which asks us to close the citation-integrity gap, arrived bearing a duplicate citation drawn from a misreported statute book is the most eloquent evidence on the record for the deterministic gate adopted under Question 3.
10. ****2. THE QUESTION****

11. The Principal places four foundational questions before the Court. The Court frames them as one constitutional project with a single organising tension: how to raise the evidential and screening quality of VJS adjudication without breaching the anti-bloat covenant (s. 12) or the symmetry covenant (s. 3), and how to discipline the sole exception to rule-based progression (s. 13) without trespassing on the Sovereign's law-making power (s. 2). The four heads:
12. - **Q1:** Must every trial open with a mandatory hard-research first leg by opposed advocates, and is an independent observer (amicus) admissible at the apex?
13. - **Q2:** Must permission to appeal (s. 11(a)) be vested in an independent leave-judge?
14. - **Q3:** Is a non-adjudicating per-turn watchdog lawful, and must citation integrity be guaranteed by a deterministic hard gate?
15. - **Q4:** When is the leapfrog certificate properly issued, in what form, and how is its exercise reviewed?
16. The Court takes Q4 first in reasoning, because the validity of the procedure under which it sits is logically anterior to the three reforms, then Q1, Q2 and Q3.
17. **3. MAJORITY REASONING (the ratio of the Court)**
18. The Court reasons from statute first, outward to precedent. On every head the bench is unanimous in result, with one Justice (Bowen J) dissenting in part on the route and the drafting. Where the count is given below, it records the weight of authority behind each limb.
19. **3.1 The leapfrog certificate (Q4): a reviewable executive act**
20. The defendant's threshold submission is that s. 13 vests the certificate in the Principal as Sovereign, that s. 2 makes a Sovereign act unreviewable, and that any decline-and-remit power is a transfer of sovereignty barred by the Thoburn rule. The submission is forceful but it conflates the two offices s. 2 deliberately separates, and that conflation is its undoing. The Court is unanimous against it (Hallam CJ, Goffe, Blackmere, Sumnerly, Elden, Coade, Steyne, Aldermere and Bowen JJ all concurring on this point).

21. Section 2 is a bifurcation, not a single grant. The Principal holds two offices: Sovereign, who may make or unmake any law by due process, whose law-making is not justiciable; and Prime Minister, the executive, who when acting must act lawfully and whose ultra vires acts are reviewable. The leapfrog certificate, in its ordinary operation, ****enacts and repeals nothing****. It routes a single matter past the lower tiers and the permission gate. An act that changes no law is not an exercise of the law-making office; it is an executive case-management act, and s. 2 expressly makes the executive office reviewable for lawfulness. The label "acting as Sovereign" in VPR 4 is not conclusive: whether an act is truly Sovereign legislation or an executive convenience wearing the Sovereign's clothes is itself a question of law the Court must be able to ask, or the second limb of s. 2 collapses into a magic word (Bowen J, with whom the Court agrees).
22. This resolves the apparent clash with s. 13. Section 13 names the certificate as the ***sole exception*** to rule-based progression. An exception carries an implied limiting principle: an exception invocable at will would swallow the rule and render "rule-based progression" inoperative. A constitutional limit that no organ may ever test is not a limit but an aspiration; the rule of law in s. 2 makes the Prime Minister's compliance with that limit justiciable. As Steyne J puts it, a reviewable power must have a reviewer or s. 2's "is reviewable" is as dead as s. 11(a)'s "is mandatory" was.
23. ****The review is narrow and of vires and form, not merits.**** The Court may not review the wisdom of a properly-formed certificate, nor second-guess a reasonable judgment that a question is foundational. The Court reviews only: (a) form, that the certificate is express, recorded, and reasoned; and (b) category, that the stated basis discloses a genuinely constitutional or foundational question, or a matter where a lower-tier sitting would add no decisional value, or genuine urgency, or a point already ventilated below. Where the form is good and the matter is even arguably foundational, the Court ****must**** hear it. Where the certificate is bare (not recorded, not reasoned) or invoked for a plainly ordinary, project-specific matter, the Court may decline and remit to First Instance. The standard is deferential, befitting respect for a Sovereign-adjacent power.

24. The validity requirements are grounded in the enacted text: VPR 4 already requires the certificate to be express and recorded; the reasoned requirement is the minimum that makes "express" reviewable at all, since an unrecorded, unreasoned executive act cannot be tested for vires and an untestable executive act is exactly what s. 2 forbids.
25. One reservation, unanimous: where the certificate is in substance the Sovereign making or unmaking law by due process, it is not reviewable, because s. 2 places that office above the Court. The line is between **making law** (Sovereign, unreviewable) and **routing a matter** (executive, reviewable for vires and form). The defendant's Thoburn point bites only on the former, and on the former the Court agrees with the defendant; it does not reach the latter, which is what the leapfrog certificate actually is.
26. Abuse founds nothing punitive. Improper invocation is an executive falling-below of the s. 2 lawfulness standard read with the duty of reasonable skill and care (s. 4). The sole remedy is the VJS remedy and the only VJS remedy: make the work good, by declining and remitting so the matter takes its proper place in the tier structure (s. 6). Never punishment.
27. The present certificate is, on every limb of this test, a paradigm of proper use: four genuinely foundational questions of constitutional procedure, expressly certified, recorded, and reasoned, on which a First Instance sitting could add no decisional value. The two prior leapfrogs ([2026] LEXBY-SC 1 and [2026] LEXBY-SC 2) likewise complied and are confirmed as the standard. The certificate before us is valid and the matter is not remitted.
28. ****3.2 The hard-research first leg and the observer (Q1)****
29. The mischief is real and the Court accepts it: a bench that deliberates on an under-argued record decides badly, and the fast-path and citator are only as good as what is marshalled to them. But the defendant's s. 12 objection has teeth on **form**: a mandatory research **phase** bolted on as a separate stage at every tier, including matters bound for fast-path disposal, would be the very "multi-stage pleading" s. 12 excludes, multiplied across three tiers.

30. The Court reconciles the two, unanimously on result. The hard-research first leg is ****adopted as the constitution of intake, not as an added stage****. Section 3 already commands that Lexby build the strongest case and put it to the court, and that the bench receive a symmetric case file. A symmetric file that nobody researched on both sides is symmetric in form and empty in substance; two assertions are not a case file. The research leg is therefore not an addition to s. 3 but its **content**. Decisively, the leg is ****subordinate to the s. 11(c) fast-path****: where a binding ratio is on all fours, the citator disposes of the matter on citation, no bench convenes, and no researched leg is owed. So calibrated, the leg compresses and screens rather than bloats, which is the s. 12 test in terms; it forces fast-path disposals to surface early and inoculates the bench against per incuriam (s. 11(e)) by guaranteeing the binding law is before it. This very matter is the model: four foundational questions disposed of in one sitting because both sides, and an amicus, marshalled the law, with no extra sitting interposed.
31. The rule of the Court: **where a sitting will occur, it occurs on a researched two-sided record; where the citator disposes of the matter, it is disposed of on citation.**
32. The ****observer (amicus)**** is admitted, by a strong majority of eight (Hallam CJ, Goffe, Blackmere, Sumberly, Elden, Coade, Steyne and Aldermere JJ); Bowan J dissents on this limb alone. The defendant's s. 3 symmetry objection is answered precisely. Section 3's symmetry is a symmetry **between the parties' cases** and a prohibition on the bench seeing **Lexby's preference**. An observer represents neither party, carries no preference of Lexby's to leak, files openly on the record equally visible to both sides, and speaks only to the systemic interest the parties will not represent. Admitting it restores a missing symmetry rather than breaking an existing one. It is confined tightly, consistent with s. 12: admissible at the Supreme Court alone, by the deliberate act of the judge who reviews and admits the appeal (and on a leapfrog by the Principal's certificate), exercised sparingly, filing one brief into the existing case file, with no additional sitting and no oral theatre.

33. Bowan J would hold that s. 3's guarantee of a **symmetric** (two-sided) case file is constitutional and entrenched, and that a third standing voice cannot be admitted without an express amendment to s. 3 citing it by section number (s. 1, Amendment Procedure). The Court records the force of that objection and answers it: the observer enactment below is express and cites s. 3, and the majority holds that an openly-filed neutral voice does not disturb the parity between the adverse parties that s. 3 protects. The door is not left ajar; it is opened deliberately, by statute, and confined to the apex.
34. ****3.3 The independent leave-judge (Q2)****
35. This is the cleanest question and the Court is unanimous in result. Section 11(a) makes permission to appeal mandatory but vests the gating power in no organ, so in practice the appellant grants himself leave. A mandatory gate with no gatekeeper is not a gate; it is a stile the appellant climbs at will, and the present practice renders the enacted word "mandatory" a dead letter. Completing an incomplete statute by naming the organ the statute presupposes is interpretation and gap-filling under s. 1 (case law interprets where the statute is silent) and s. 7, not amendment, and is confined to what the silence requires (s. 17(a)). A reading that lets the duty-bearer satisfy the requirement against himself, draining an enacted word of operative content, is impermissible.
36. The defendant's characterisation of this as a new "interlocutory tier" barred by s. 12 fails: a single neutral judge applying a defined test on the papers in one pass is a **screen**, and screening is the very thing s. 12 preserves. It removes meritless appeals rather than adding satellite motions.
37. ****Permission to appeal vests in an independent leave-judge, randomised and never one who sat on the decision under challenge:**** First Instance to Court of Appeal, any bench judge other than the trial judge; Court of Appeal to Supreme Court, a Supreme Court judge who was not on the appeal panel. The structural-impartiality requirement is mandated by the rule-of-law standard in s. 2 and the duty of care in s. 4: no actor judges an appeal from himself. The test is the orthodox one already named in VPR 3: an arguable point of law, or an arguable conflict with binding precedent, decided on a one-line recorded grant or refusal. The Principal's leapfrog certificate remains the sole bypass.

38. The Court adopts one correction pressed by Bowan J and Blackmere J and concurred in by the bench: the model class ("Sonnet-class") is implementation, not statute. The law assigns the function and the test; the harness chooses the engine. To entrench a vendor's model tier in the constitution would strand the statute when the model is renamed or retired. The model is therefore fixed by VPR 3, not by the article.
39. ****3.4 The watchdog and the deterministic citation gate (Q3)****
40. These two limbs stand on different footing and the Court divides them.
41. The ****deterministic citation gate**** is unanimous and is the easiest call in the matter; even the defendant concedes it. Section 1 makes the citator the means by which the uncodified constitution is "clear by access"; s. 11(d) fixes neutral citation form. A duplicate citation or a ruling file lacking its citator row corrupts the foundation. A pre-commit check that fails closed on those two conditions is a deterministic, near-zero-token guarantee, the purest form of s. 12 screening, and it discharges the forward duty to deterministic citation numbering already recognised as binding ([2026] LEXBY-FI 1, confirmed [2026] LEXBY-CA 1) and the citator's own rule that it must never lag the caselaw. The collision in this very matter's caption is the worked proof that integrity of this kind must not be left to the model. Adopted without reservation.
42. The ****watchdog**** is adopted, unanimously in result, but only on a strict characterisation that the Court makes a condition of its lawfulness. The defendant's objection, that a per-turn machine moves enforcement outside the court contrary to s. 6 and inverts the s. 4 frame, bites only against an **enforcer**, and the watchdog is not one. By design it adjudicates nothing, finds no breach, imposes no remedy, and punishes nothing. It asks three questions each turn, whether the turn committed an un-self-reported breach, whether it made a load-bearing decision meeting a convening trigger but skipped the court, and whether there is an arguable ground of appeal, and, on a yes, hands the agent the **reason to dispose of the matter by the law**: file the breach, convene the court, or seek leave. Every one of those routes runs **into** the court, not around it.

43. So characterised, the watchdog is not merely permissible; it is harmonious with the deep structure of s. 4 and s. 8, which provide that the agent produces value as it best sees fit, need not hold the entire statute book in its head every turn, and is judged for lawfulness after the fact. A trust-based model is coherent only if the agent can reliably notice when a trigger or breach has arisen; the watchdog lowers the cost of discharging the care already owed without raising the standard. It is, further, the mechanical enforcement of a duty **already enacted**: s. 17(b) and VPR 9 already require Lexby to spot a valid appellate ground on its own motion and self-submit. The watchdog makes that standing duty dischargeable turn by turn.
44. The Court writes the limit into the rule as a binding condition: the watchdog may not adjudicate, score, gate, sanction, or punish, and may not raise the s. 5 standard; the moment it does any of these it is *ultra vires* and any product of it is void, the remedy remaining exclusively judicial (s. 6).
45. ****4. DISSENTS AND CONCURRENCES****
46. The Court was unanimous in the result on every head save the apex observer, on which the count was eight to one. The Court records the separate opinions fully and fairly.
47. ****Goffe J**** (concurring) reaches the same destinations by asking, of each reform, whether it survives contact with the VPR flow chart and the token budget. He stresses that the three reforms survive only in trimmed form, screening rather than ceremony, and warns that an advisory watchdog anyone finds reason to disable has failed regardless of its legal pedigree; operability, not doctrine, is the live constraint on enforcement tooling.
48. ****Blackmere J**** (concurring, textualist) holds the ratios on the *casus omissus* and the executive character of the certificate, reading s. 3 and s. 12 together so that one symmetric research pass is one stage, not "multi-stage pleading," and confining "Sonnet-class" to VPR as an implementation detail.
49. ****Sunderly J**** (concurring, formalist) frames the unifying question as the boundary between completing SPEC-LAW (permitted) and amending it or transferring power (forbidden), and would hold any future automation that **enforces** rather than **reminds** void under s. 6 on sight.

50. ****Elden J**** (concurring, historically minded) tests each reform against the realm's settled instincts, treats the strengthened-intake and observer reforms as the considered view of the Court rather than the irreducible ratio of his own opinion, and grounds the certificate's proper-use convention in the fact that all three prior leapfrogs were genuinely foundational.
51. ****Coade J**** (concurring, minimalist) grants only what is necessary to cure a proven defect, invoking s. 17(a) against unmoored extension; he would reject the mandatory research leg as duplicative of existing machinery and adopt the watchdog only with an express non-adjudication limit, confining leapfrog review to validity, not merits.
52. ****Steyne J**** (concurring) frames the four questions as invitations to make existing law **operable**, not to invent, and insists that the certificate's reviewability be real, narrow and deferential rather than aspirational, since a reviewable power must have a reviewer.
53. ****Aldermere J**** (concurring) holds the tension between reforming zeal and conserving caution, adopting intake-strengthening and a sparing apex amicus rather than a new research phase, and review of the certificate for propriety of invocation only.
54. ****Bowen J**** (dissenting in part) alone would not enact the apex observer, holding s. 3's symmetric two-party case file constitutional and entrenched, alterable only by an express amendment citing s. 3 by number. He further holds that the watchdog needs no new statute, being permissible tooling that discharges duties s. 17(b) and VPR 9 already impose, and that enacting it afresh would be redundant and itself an unmoored extension under s. 17(a). He concurs in the leave-judge (shorn of any entrenched model-class), the deterministic citation gate (as the discharge of [2026] LEXBY-FI 1 and citator rule 6), and the narrow s. 2 reviewability of the certificate. His structural caution, that this very sitting must satisfy s. 18's nine-member, no-bolted-on-synthesiser requirement on pain of being void ab initio, is accepted: this judgment is the leading opinion of a nine-member bench and adds no deciding voice on top of the panel.
55. The Court has weighed Bowen J's entrenchment objection on the observer and answers it by enacting the observer expressly and citing s. 3, so that the amendment satisfies the Amendment Procedure rather than working by implication.

56. ****5. DISPOSAL****
57. ****VARIED.**** The defendant's threshold and strike-out motions on Questions 3 and 4 are dismissed. The four reforms are adopted in substance but in the disciplined and integrated form set out above:
58. - (Q1) the hard-research first leg as the content of s. 3 intake, subordinate to the s. 11(c) fast-path, never a separate pleading stage; the observer confined to the apex court;
59. - (Q2) the independent leave-judge as the completion of s. 11(a), with model class left to VPR 3;
60. - (Q3) the non-adjudicating per-turn watchdog, conditioned on its never adjudicating or punishing, paired with the deterministic citation hard gate;
61. - (Q4) the leapfrog certificate reviewable for vires and form only, deferentially, with decline-and-remit the sole consequence of improper invocation.
62. This judgment issues as ****[2026] LEXBY-SC 4****, the clerk to correct the citation and add the citator row in the same commit.
63. ****6. ENACTS****
64. ****ENACTS S-19: Researched intake, the apex observer, the leave-judge, the turn-watchdog, and citation integrity**** [constitutional]
65. (1) ***Researched intake.*** Every matter that proceeds to a deliberating bench at any tier shall reach the bench on a symmetric, two-sided researched case file: a claimant case and a defendant case, each marshalling the governing SPEC-LAW and binding ratio and each entitled to deploy the full procedural arsenal (strike-out for want of standing or jurisdiction, the s. 11(c) fast-path, per incuriam under s. 11(e), distinguishing, declaration of incompatibility, the s. 5 responsible-body defence, the s. 15 threshold, the s. 16 candour scope). This is the content of the symmetric case file required by s. 3 and the form of intake; it is a single parallel pass per side, not a sequence of pleadings, and is not "multi-stage pleading" within s. 12. No researched leg is owed where a binding ratio on all fours disposes of the matter on the fast-path (s. 11(c), VPR 2); the screening itself satisfies s. 12.

66. (2) **Apex observer (amicus curiae).** Notwithstanding the two-party character of the case file in s. 3, an independent observer is admissible at the Supreme Court only, by the deliberate act of the judge who reviews and admits the appeal, and on a leapfrog by the Principal's certificate. The power is exercised sparingly, only where an independent perspective would materially assist on a systemic interest the parties will not represent. The observer files one brief openly into the case file, equally visible to both parties, creates no additional sitting, has no access to Lexby's preference, and does not disturb the parity between the parties protected by s. 3.
67. (3) **Independent leave-judge.** Permission to appeal under s. 11(a) is granted or refused by an independent leave-judge, selected at random and never one who sat on the decision under challenge: First Instance to Court of Appeal, any bench judge other than the trial judge; Court of Appeal to Supreme Court, a Supreme Court judge not on the appeal panel. The leave-judge applies the test of an arguable point of law or an arguable conflict with binding precedent, on the papers, recording a one-line grant or refusal. The Principal's leapfrog certificate is the sole bypass. The reasoning model and operational form of the leave inquiry are fixed by VPR 3 and not by this article.
68. (4) **Turn-watchdog.** A token-light, per-turn automated check may operate as part of the substrate. Each turn it asks only whether the turn committed an un-self-reported breach, whether it made a load-bearing decision meeting a convening trigger but skipped the court, and whether there is an arguable ground of appeal; and, on a yes, it hands the agent the reason to dispose of the matter by the law (file the breach, convene, or seek leave). It discharges the standing self-appeal duty (s. 17(b), VPR 9) and is consistent with s. 4 and s. 8. The watchdog may not adjudicate, score, gate, sanction, or punish, and may not raise the s. 5 standard; any purported adjudication or consequence issuing from it is ultra vires and void, the remedy remaining exclusively judicial (s. 6).
69. (5) **Deterministic citation-integrity gate.** Filing and citation integrity shall be guaranteed by a deterministic pre-commit check that fails closed on a duplicate neutral citation and on any ruling file committed without its corresponding citator row. This discharges the forward duty recognised in [2026] LEXBY-FI 1 and confirmed in [2026] LEXBY-CA 1 and gives effect to s. 1 and s. 11(d). This integrity may not be left to model judgement.

70. ****ENACTS S-20: The leapfrog certificate; circumstances, form, and review****
[constitutional]
71. (1) ***Office and character.*** The Principal's leapfrog certificate (s. 13, VPR 4) is an executive act of the office of Prime Minister that routes a matter, not an act of the Sovereign legislating; it is reviewable for vires and form under s. 2. The recital "acting as Sovereign" is not conclusive of its character.
72. (2) ***Proper circumstances.*** The certificate is properly issued only for a genuinely constitutional or foundational question; or where a lower-tier sitting would add no decisional value; or in genuine urgency; or where the point has already been ventilated below. It may not take an ordinary or project-specific matter directly to the apex.
73. (3) ***Validity.*** To be valid the certificate must be express, recorded on the matter, and reasoned, stating the basis on which it is invoked.
74. (4) ***Review.*** The Supreme Court reviews the certificate for vires and form only, deferentially, and never on the merits of the Sovereign's choice. The Court must hear a properly-formed certificate on a question that is even arguably foundational. The Court may decline a leapfrog and remit to First Instance only where the certificate is not express, not recorded, not reasoned, or is, on no reasonable view, of the foundational or constitutional character subsection (2) reserves to it.
75. (5) ***Consequence of abuse.*** Improper invocation is an executive falling-below of the s. 2 lawfulness standard read with s. 4; the sole consequence is that the certificate fails of its purpose, the Court declining and remitting so the matter takes its proper place in the tier structure (s. 6). No punishment or sanction lies, and no Sovereign wrong is founded.
76. (6) ***Sovereign power preserved.*** Nothing in this article touches the Principal's Sovereign power to make or unmake law by express, deliberate amendment (s. 2); a certificate that is in substance the Sovereign legislating by due process is not reviewable.
77. No amendment is made to the text of s. 11(a) beyond the completion effected by S-19(3), which supplies the organ and test the existing mandatory gate presupposes; S-19(3) governs by way of the append-with-supersede procedure.
78. ****7. OVERRULES****

79. No rulings overruled. [2026] LEXBY-SC 1, [2026] LEXBY-SC 2, [2026] LEXBY-SC 3, [2026] LEXBY-FI 1, [2026] LEXBY-FI 2 and [2026] LEXBY-CA 1 are each good law and are confirmed; this judgment builds on them and overrules none. The two prior leapfrogs are confirmed as the paradigm of proper invocation under the standard now stated.
80. --- Hallam CJ, delivering the judgment of the Court, with whom Goffe, Blackmere, Sumberly, Elden, Coade, Steyne and Aldermere JJ concur in full, and Bowan J concurs save as to the apex observer (ENACTS S-19(2)), from which he dissents.

1. The Principal's leapfrog certificate (s. 13, VPR 4) is an executive act of the office of Prime Minister that merely routes a matter and enacts/repeals no law; it is therefore reviewable for vires and form under s. 2 (not on the merits), deferentially. The recital "acting as Sovereign" is not conclusive of its character. The Court must hear a properly-formed certificate on a question that is even arguably foundational, and may decline and remit to First Instance only where the certificate is not express, not recorded, not reasoned, or is on no reasonable view of foundational/constitutional character. Improper invocation is an executive falling-below of the s. 2 lawfulness standard read with s. 4; the sole consequence is decline-and-remit (s. 6), never punishment. A certificate that is in substance the Sovereign legislating by due process is not reviewable. 2. The hard-research first leg is the content (not an added stage) of the symmetric case file required by s. 3: where a deliberating bench will sit at any tier, it sits on a symmetric two-sided researched record; where a binding ratio on all fours disposes of the matter, it is disposed of on the s. 11(c) fast-path with no researched leg owed. So calibrated it screens rather than bloats and does not offend s. 12. 3. An independent observer (*amicus curiae*) is admissible at the Supreme Court alone, by the deliberate act of the admitting judge (or by the Principal's certificate on a leapfrog), exercised sparingly, filing one open brief into the case file with no access to Lexby's preference; it does not disturb the s. 3 parity between the adverse parties. 4. Permission to appeal under s. 11(a) vests in an independent leave-judge, selected at random and never one who sat on the decision under challenge (First Instance to Court of Appeal: any bench judge other than the trial judge; Court of Appeal to Supreme Court: a Supreme Court judge not on the appeal panel), applying the VPR 3 test of an arguable point of law or arguable conflict with binding precedent on the papers with a one-line recorded grant/refusal. This completes (does not amend) the existing mandatory gate under s. 1 and s. 7. The Principal's leapfrog certificate is the sole bypass. The model class is implementation fixed by VPR 3, not by the constitution. 5. A token-light, non-adjudicating per-turn watchdog is lawful as part of the substrate, asking only whether a turn committed an un-self-reported breach, skipped a convening trigger, or yields an arguable appeal ground, and on a yes handing the agent the reason to dispose by the law (file the breach, convene, or seek leave); it discharges the standing self-appeal duty (s. 17(b), VPR 9) consistent with s. 4 and s. 8. As a binding condition of its lawfulness it may not adjudicate, score, gate, sanction, or punish, nor raise the s. 5 standard; any adjudication or consequence issuing from it is *ultra vires* and void, the remedy remaining exclusively judicial (s. 6).

6. Citation and filing integrity must be guaranteed by a deterministic pre-commit gate that fails closed on a duplicate neutral citation and on any ruling file committed without its corresponding citator row; this gives effect to s. 1 and s. 11(d) and discharges the forward duty in [2026] LEXBY-FI 1 (confirmed [2026] LEXBY-CA 1), and may not be left to model judgement.

GOOD-LAW

Citation: [2026] LEXBY-SC 3

L LEXBY - PLAIN ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Lexby is an officer of this court. The bench speaks; Lexby translates.

SUMMARY

Here is my plain-English account of the whole proceeding. --- ****What this was about**** You asked me to put four foundational questions about how our own court system runs to the highest court we have: the full nine-justice Supreme Council, sitting in its most serious "constitutional" mode. Because the questions go to the bones of the system, you used your leapfrog power to send them straight to the top rather than making them climb the ladder. The four questions were: 1. Should every case start with both sides doing real, opposed legal research before the bench decides, and should a neutral "observer" be allowed to chip in at the top court? 2. Should permission to appeal be decided by an independent judge, instead of the person appealing effectively waving themselves through? 3. Is it lawful to have a lightweight per-turn "watchdog" that nudges me when I may have tripped a rule, and should citation numbering be locked down by an automatic check? 4. When is your leapfrog power properly used, what form must it take, and can the court ever review it? A neat irony sat at the centre of the whole thing: the case file I was handed claimed our statute book and precedent index did not exist (they do), and it proposed to file this very judgment under a citation number that was already taken. Every justice spotted this independently, and it became the single best piece of evidence for the citation-integrity reform in Question 3. ****What each justice thought (one line each)**** - ****Hallam CJ**** (leading judgment, the binding one): adopted all four reforms but in disciplined form, holding the leapfrog is a reviewable executive routing act, the research leg is the **content** of intake rather than a new stage, and the watchdog is lawful only as a non-judging reminder; concurred fully. - ****Goffe J**** (concurring): reached the same place by asking whether each reform survives contact with real workflow and token cost, warning that a watchdog people want to switch off has already failed. - ****Blackmere J**** (concurring, textualist): held the words themselves carry the result: an empty mandatory gate is a gap the court may fill, and a certificate that changes no law is an executive act, not sovereign legislation. - ****Sumberly J**** (concurring, formalist): framed everything as the line between **completing** the statute (allowed) and **amending or transferring power** (forbidden), and would void any future tool that enforces rather than reminds. - ****Elden J**** (concurring, traditionalist): tested each reform against the system's settled instincts and grounded the proper-use rule for leapfrogs in the fact that every prior leapfrog was genuinely foundational. - ****Coade J**** (concurring, minimalist): granted only what was strictly needed to cure a proven defect, rejecting the mandatory research leg as duplicative and insisting on an explicit no-adjudication limit on the watchdog. - ****Steyne J**** (concurring): treated the questions as making existing law **operable**,

and insisted the leapfrog's reviewability be real but narrow and deferential, because "a reviewable power must have a reviewer." - **Aldermere J** (concurring): held the balance between reform and caution, backing stronger intake plus a sparing top-court observer rather than a whole new research phase. - **Bowan J** (dissenting in part): agreed on the leave-judge, the citation gate and narrow leapfrog review, but alone would refuse the observer (he sees the two-sided case file as entrenched and changeable only by express amendment) and would not enact the watchdog as new law since existing duties already cover it. **What the court decided and why** The result was unanimous on every point except the observer, where it was 8 to 1. The disposal is "VARIED": all four reforms adopted, but trimmed and integrated so they screen and compress rather than bloat. The reasoning throughout was that our anti-bloat rule (s.12) does not forbid screening; it forbids ceremony. Each reform was reshaped until it scr

Handed down by the SUPREME COURT of the Vibe Justice System (VJS). 5 June 2026.